

Inner Temple

No. 155

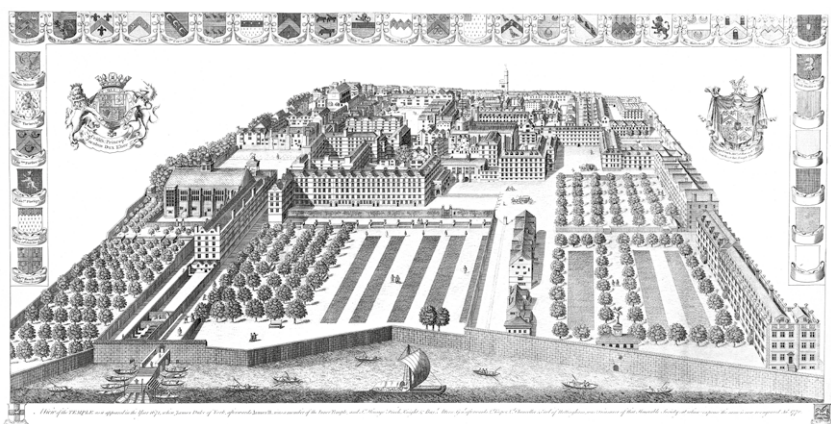
THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

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The Inner Temple is one of the four Inns of Court in England and Wales, responsible for training, regulating, and admitting barristers. It is governed by a council called "Parliament" and the Bench Table made up of senior members, known as Benchers.

The land was originally given to the Knights Templar in 1184 and later passed to the Knights Hospitallers. Lawyers settled there around 1339, forming the Inner and Middle Temples. The Temple was damaged during the 1381 Wat Tyler rebellion and rebuilt later. In 1608, King James I granted the land to the Benchers to support legal education.

In earlier centuries, students learned law by attending court sessions and taking part in mock trials, giving rise to terms like "called to the Bar" and "sitting on the bench." The Inner Temple has a rich history of notable members, including writers, leaders, pioneering women barristers, and royal Benchers. Today, it remains an active legal institution with over 8,000 members.



The Temple in 1671



Inner Temple Pegasus